

9.4 Caution

People who are regular Net users and aware of the dubious nature of online identity will realise that Orkut can be an excellent hunting ground for people with malicious intent. People entering the site for the first time and eager to befriend the entire Orkut family can easily fall prey to such people and schemes. Caution needs to be exercised when dealing with others, no matter what information is provided on the site. It is really easy for a person to create multiple identities and increase the rankings and ratings of one of them. To have a safe stay at Orkut the following tips could be useful.

1. Never give out personal information to friends who have recently befriended you.
2. Avoid clicking on spam messages that regularly show up in the community forum.
3. Identity thieves will try to hijack your Orkut account by sending an e-mail asking for your username and password. Such e-mails are better deleted or marked as spam. Ensure that the page you enter your username and password is at orkut.com.
4. Evaluate the nature of information provided in your profile. Avoid information and pictures that could be misused. Email IDs, if made public, can and will attract spam messages. Phone numbers and physical addresses are best left blank in the profile. Using a secondary email ID for Orkut is also recommended.
5. If you are at the receiving end of persistent unwanted attention, feel free to inform Orkut.